



Slides 05.12: Comparing the Same Item Across Stores, Secondhand, and Online

Lesson 5.12, two days (days 131 and 132). Slides 1 to 12 are Day 1. Slides 13 to 18 are Day 2. All prices marked [update].

Slide 1: Day 1. Do now

- Four sweatshirts are on the table.
- Write what you think each one cost. A, B, C, D.
- Then circle the one you would buy.
- Two minutes.

Notes: take four guesses out loud and write the spread on the board. Then the hook: one of these cost four dollars more than another and will last three times as long, and nobody can tell which from here.

Image: four hooded sweatshirts hanging in a row with blank price tags.

Slide 2: Day 1. Four kinds of places

- Discount store
- Mall brand store
- Secondhand shop
- Online marketplace
- Same item. Four prices. Four different levels of quality.

Image: four small icons in a row: a big-box aisle, a mall storefront, a thrift rack, a phone screen with a listing.

Slide 3: Day 1. Discount store and mall brand

- **Discount store.** Lowest tag price. Available today. Easy free returns.
- Risk: thinner fabric, fewer stitches per inch, single-needle seams, narrow size range.
- **Mall brand.** Better construction. Wider sizes. Free returns. You can try it on.
- Risk: you pay for the brand and the store, so the same quality costs more.

Slide 4: Day 1. Secondhand shop

- Best quality for the price. Often heavier fabric than a new discount item.
- Keeps a garment in use instead of in a landfill.
- You can inspect it in your hands before you pay.
- Risk: one size only. Sold as-is. No returns. May have a flaw or hidden wear.
- Risk: it will not be there tomorrow.

Image: a rack of used sweatshirts with handwritten price tags.

Slide 5: Day 1. Online marketplace

- Widest choice. Often the lowest listed price.
- Risk: you cannot touch it.
- Risk: shipping and returns cost money.
- Risk: sizing is a guess from a chart.
- Risk: you wait. Sometimes weeks.

Notes: hold up the shipping bag here but do not open it yet. Step 3 opens it.

Slide 6: Day 1. Quality check 1: seam strength

- Hold the fabric on both sides of a seam.
- Pull gently sideways.
- Look for gaps, loose thread, or the seam opening.
- Good: nothing moves, no thread shows.

Notes: demonstrate on garment A for ten seconds. Pull gently. Say “gently” twice.

Image: two hands pulling a seam apart slightly, close up, with a small gap visible.

Slide 7: Day 1. Quality check 2: fabric weight

- Hold it up to the light against a white card.
- Heavier fabric blocks more light.
- Feel the weight in your hand.
- Good: for a sweatshirt, about 9 ounces or more is heavy.

Image: a flashlight behind a thin fleece, light coming through, next to a heavy fleece blocking it.

Slide 8: Day 1. Quality check 3: stitch density

- Lay the ruler on a seam. Count the stitches in one inch.
- 8 per inch is low.
- 10 to 12 per inch holds.
- Count the seam that holds the garment together, not the decorative topstitching.

Notes: this is the mistake every class makes. Show both seams on garment A and name the difference before the rotation starts.

Image: a ruler laid along a seam with individual stitches visible.

Slide 9: Day 1. Quality check 4: read the label

- Fiber content, with percentages
- Care instructions
- Country of manufacture
- Is there a brand label at all?
- No percentages means you do not know what you are buying.

Image: a garment care label with fiber percentages and wash symbols.

Slide 10: Day 1. The hidden costs of buying online

- Listed price \$9.99 *[update]*
- Plus shipping \$_____
- Plus sales tax \$_____
- **What you actually paid \$_____**
- If it does not fit: return shipping \$_____

- Days you waited: _____
- The five hidden costs: shipping, return shipping, a restocking or return fee, sizing risk, time.

Notes: pass the shipping bag and the packing slip. Build the landed cost on the board from the real slip. Ask: the listing said \$9.99. What did it cost to get one that fits?

Slide 11: Day 1. The reveal

- Garment A: \$ _____ , _____
- Garment B: \$ _____ , _____
- Garment C: \$ _____ , _____
- Garment D: \$ _____ , _____
- Compare to the guesses on the board.

Notes: *[Sal: fill in your four real prices and vendor types.]* Ask which garment scored best on stitch density and whether that matched its price. Usually it did not.

Slide 12: Day 1. Exit card

- 3 quality checks you can now run on a garment
- 2 hidden costs of buying clothes online
- 1 question you still have about where to buy clothes

Notes: two students read one line. Sort the cards. A big “needs more” pile means Day 2 opens with 90 seconds on stitch density.

Slide 13: Day 2. Do now

- Yesterday you counted stitches per inch.
- Which of the four sweatshirts would you buy for a little cousin who is about to grow two inches? Why?
- One sentence.

Notes: take two answers. Hook: today the buyer is not you. You get a buyer, eight items, and ten minutes to make a recommendation you can defend.

Slide 14: Day 2. The task and the rules

- Your station gets one buyer card and one spec sheet of eight items.
- Your recommendation must name:
 - one item, and the total your buyer pays including shipping and tax
 - two quality checks that support the choice
 - one hidden cost you accepted or avoided
 - the second-best item, and why it lost
- Everybody at the station signs the poster.

Notes: have them read the buyer card out loud at the station and underline the three limits: money, time, size.

Slide 15: Day 2. The poster template

- OUR BUYER IS:
- WE RECOMMEND ITEM:
- TOTAL THE BUYER PAYS: \$_____
- QUALITY REASON 1:
- QUALITY REASON 2:
- ONE HIDDEN COST WE ACCEPTED OR AVOIDED:
- SECOND BEST, AND WHY IT LOST:

Slide 16: Day 2. Sentence frames

- We recommend item ___ for ___ because ___.
- The total is \$___ , under the buyer's limit of \$___ .
- Item ___ has ___ stitches per inch and ___ seams, which means ___.
- We avoided the hidden cost of ___ by ___.
- Item ___ lost because ___.

Slide 17: Day 2. Defend it

- 90 seconds to present.
- 90 seconds of questions from the other two stations, plus one from me.
- Write your questions for the other stations before they present.
- My question may be the hard one.

Notes: ask at least one station: your buyer needs it Monday, your item ships in 12 to 20 days, answer that.

Slide 18: Day 2. Closure

- The item I recommended was _____.
- If my buyer had twice the money, I would have said _____ instead, because _____.
- Turn in the handout and the poster.

Notes: three students read. These lines come back out in Lesson 5.14 Day 2, where each student builds a comparison alone.